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Seeley thumps young Eagles

By JON KASPER
of the Missoulian

Valley Christian fans aren't accustomed to watching their boys' basketball team lose. But Coach Jeff Snyder's Eagles have rarely been this inexperienced.

Seeley-Swan downed the winless Eagles 67-53 in a District 13-C contest at the Valley Christian gym Saturday night.

The loss dropped the Eagles to 0-3, their worst start in Snyder's six years as head coach. Valley Christian lost just five games all of last year, en route to the Western C title and a berth in the state tournament.

The Eagles scored just 17 first-half points, and never got their halfcourt offense in sync. Marty Gibbons, the only player who saw extensive varsity time last season, led Valley Chirstian with 12 points.

"We definitely need to work on our man-to-man defense," Synder said. "We gave them too many easy baskets. We're working a bit of new offense and the chemistry is not right. It's tough for them. I'm limiting them to inside shots and they're getting stymied."

Seeley-Swan (3-1) had three players in double figures. Senior center Jesse Boone led the way with 17 points, including 9 of 9 free throws. Senior Mike Larson added 16 and junior guard Matt Schneiter netted 13.

The Blackhawks shot just 38 percent from the floor and hit just 3-of-19 3-point attempts. Seeley-Swan did have success with its transition game, set up by 20 turnovers.

"I think Seeley out-hustled us," Snyder said. "They were all over the floor. They got every loose ball. That helped their transition a lot."

Seeley-Swan led the entire way and opened up a 33-17 halftime lead with a 13-2 run in the final four minutes of the first half.

The Blackhawks led by as many as 16 in the second half. Twice Valley Christian cut the lead to 12, only to have Seeley-Swan answer back with 3-pointers.

Seeley-Swan	15	18	16	18	–	67
Valley Christian	9	8	20	16	–	53

SEELEY-SWAN (3-1, 3-1) – Pat Morin 3-7 2-2 8, Abe Kats 3-7 1-2 8, Matt Schneiter 5-15 2-4 13, Jesse Boone 4-10 9-9 17, Mike Larson 7-14 1-1 16, Leif Ibsen 1-7 3-5 5, James Webb 0-1 0-3 0. Totals 23-61 18-26 67.

VALLEY CHRISTIAN (0-3, 0-3) – Marty Gibbons 6-10 0-0 12, Jeremy Betty 2-8 2-4 6, Dan Elsen 3-4 2-2 8, Bryce Miller 4-9 1-3 9, Adam McElderry 2-5 1-2 5, Britton Boedecker 3-4 1-2 7, Ryan DeGroot 1-3 2-3 4, Scott Rodli 0-1 0-0 0, Charlie Duval 1-2 0-0 2. Totals 22-46 9-16 53.

3-point goals – Seeley-Swan 3-19 (Kats 1-3, Larson 1-5, Schneiter 1-6), Valley Christian 0-1. Total fouls – Seeley-Swan 14, Valley Christian 21. Fouled out – None. Rebounds – Seeley-Swan 33 (Boone 6, Webb 6), Valley Christian 27 (Betty 6). Turnovers – Seeley-Swan 13, Valley Christian 20.

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